> Next stop later in the afternoon was Bitburg. Here the people were jamming the streets—most friendly but some demonstrators. We went to the cemetery and met General [Matthew] Ridgway, 91 years old, last surviving top World War II leader in America and Gen. Steinhoff, a German general who had been shot down in flames and whose face had been rebuilt by an American army doctor at war's end. Kohl and I and the generals walked through the tiny cemetery and then at a monument there the generals placed wreaths. The German "Taps" was played and then in a truly dramatic moment, the two generals clasped hands. There had been no leak to the press that the generals would be there. Then we motored to the air base where both German and American units are based. There were several thousand people, families of the military plus a number of citizens of Bitburg, the mayor, City Council et al. The German military band played our national anthem. Then the American band played theirs. My speech was sort of a sequel to the one at Belsen. It was enthusiastically received and our people thought it turned the issue around. I felt very good. I was told later the two generals sat holding each other's hands. General Ridgway and his wife returned to Bonn with us on AF I. Back in Schloss Gymnisch we got done up for the white tie state dinner. . . . There was a small reception, then into dinner. After dinner, there was a half hour entertainment, chamber music. Well, this was the day—everyone—well, not everyone—but much of the press had predicted would be a disaster.

One of my most memorable moments on that trip didn't occur at the cemetery, but the following day, our last in Germany, when Nancy and I and Helmut Kohl and his wife flew by helicopter to a lovely forested area and then drove up a mountain road to an ancient German castle. Along the